Timeline [tentative]

> This page is the source of truth for Clay Club Hosts acting as Clay Cup coaches.
>
> Use it to understand *what happens when*, what you're responsible for, and where Clay HQ steps in.

The Clay Cup 2026 journey is designed to move from **open participation** → **regional ownership** → **global competition**, without overwhelming hosts or participants.

🏆 Applications → Local Nomination → Online Qualifiers → IRL Semi-Finals → Grand Final

Use this table when planning calendars, delegation, and comms.

Narrative details live below.

Clay Cup Timeline

Phase	Timing (Tentative)	What Happens	H
🏆 **1. Applications Open**	Early Feb	Global applications open to eligible candidates	Prom strong quiete basic
🏆 **2. Applications Close**	3rd Week of March	Clubs need to submit the names of their representatives	Host in-per
🏆 **2. Local Nomination Events**	March (rolling)	Clubs surface 1 rep each	Decid select criteri **Club** **repre** **comp** **throu** **proce**
🏆 **3. Online Qualifiers**	April	Live, online competition rounds	Coach expec suppo
🏆 **4. IRL Semi-Finals**	May / June	Top contestants compete in select cities	If hos suppo prep
🏆 **5. Grand Final (Sculpt)**	Sculpt Conference	Finalists compete live; winner crowned	Coach journe

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Phase Details & Expectation

Phase 1: Applications Open

Host focus: awareness + encouragement. Surface talent early, don't wait for people to self-nominate.

Phase 2: Local / Virtual Nomination Events

Host focus: fairness + clarity. Publish how decisions are made. Celebrate effort, not just winners.

Phase 3: Online Qualifiers

Host focus: coaching. Help nominees practice under time pressure and understand judging criteria.

Phase 4: IRL Semi-Finals

Host focus: representation. Whether hosting or coaching, model community-first values.

Phase 5: Grand Final